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From today's featured article



Aquilegia coerulea

Aquilegia is a genus of perennial flowering plants commonly known as columbines. Part of the buttercup family, *Aquilegia* contains between 70 and 400 described species and subspecies with natural ranges across the Northern Hemisphere. *Aquilegia* first evolved in Asia, with natural and introduced populations present on all continents except Antarctica. The flowers of most columbines feature nectar spurs; variation in the length of spurs, alongside other flower attributes, evolved to attract pollinators. Popular as garden plants, columbines may have first entered cultivation 1,700 years ago. Their high physical variability and ease of hybridization has resulted in the development of many cultivated varieties. Several cultures have used columbines for medicinal purposes. Columbines have also taken on symbolic connotations: the horn-like shape of

the nectar spurs has resulted in associations with cuckoldry, while the species *Aquilegia coerulea* (*pictured*) is the state flower of Colorado. (***Full article...***)

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Did you know ...

- ... that **John A. Manke** (*pictured*) was the first person to achieve supersonic speed in a lifting-body aircraft?
- ... that the announcement of **Werewolf Gorge**, an upcoming roller coaster at Six Flags Fiesta Texas, was timed to coincide with the rising of a blue moon?
- ... that one of archivist **Jessy Randall**'s poems was added to the side of sanitation trucks in Sydney?
- ... that Ives's **Overture in G minor** has been described as "hardly recognisable as the work of Ives"?
- ... that the bird keeper of **Duck Island Cottage** was also tasked with maintaining bomb-disposal equipment?
- ... that Indonesian diplomat **Abdullah Kamil** was detained by Dutch, and later British, colonial authorities?
- ... that ***The Boy at the Back of the Class*** was described as "a nightmare to adapt for the stage"?
- ... that strontium in human teeth found at **Barsinia** matched that of local rodents, indicating that its inhabitants did not marry outsiders?
- ... that a church in San Francisco begins weekly services by sounding a conch shell?



John A. Manke with a Northrop M2-F3